

GUIDEBOOK · 2026

SASANG CONSTITUTION FENG SHUI: THE GUIDE

Space that knows who lives in it

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SASANG CONSTITUTION FENG SHUI: THE GUIDE

Feng shui centered on the people who live there — Space that knows who lives in it

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1. IN ONE SENTENCE

Sasang Constitution Feng Shui is feng shui that puts the person first, not the house. It is a method of interior design that reduces and adds the five elements of a space (material, color, form, light, scent) according to the resident's constitution, so that the space guides that person toward a state of harmony: a person of balanced yin and yang (陰陽和平之人).

2. WHAT MAKES IT NEW: HOW IT DIFFERS FROM TRADITIONAL LIVING FENG SHUI

Aspect	Traditional living feng shui	Sasang Constitution Feng Shui
Focus	The arrangement of a place, its surroundings, and the harmony of yin-yang and the five elements	**The constitution and lived experience of the person in the space**
Reading the person	Methods such as the Eight Mansions (八宅) method derive a personal trigram from birth year and sex to determine individual directions	**The person is read through the Sasang constitution (relative organ size, temperament, sensory preference)**
Design input	Direction, landform, spatial layout	Constitution consultation, preferences for light, sound and touch, daily schedule
Implementation	Interpreting the relationship between space and environment	Expressing the symbolism of color and material through adjustable lighting, furniture and circulation
Evaluation	Interpretive standards of each school	The comfort, preference and usability the resident experiences

Some branches of traditional feng shui do take the individual into account, so we do not claim that "Chinese feng shui ignores people." The distinction is that **we read the person through Sasang medicine, a distinctly Korean tradition, and translate that reading into the interior language of material, color, light and scent.** People, too, carry an energy of their own into a space.

3. PRINCIPLES

3.1 Constitutions and the five elements

Dr. Yim DongKoo's assignment (phone call on 2026-10-20; posters of 10/20 and 10/24) is as follows.

> **How to read this**: Lee Je-ma's Dongui Suse Bowon (1894) was written not in terms of the five elements but in the Sasang (四象) system of Tae, So, Eum and Yang. The correspondences below are not the orthodox doctrine of the original text; they are **Dr. Yim DongKoo's interpretive model** for carrying the Sasang constitution into spatial design.

Constitution	Element (strong organ)	Relative organ size	Weak organ (element)	Temperament keywords
Tae-eum (太陰人)	**木** (liver)	Large liver, small lungs	Lungs (金)	Embracing · enduring · prudent
So-yang (少陽人)	**土** (spleen)	Large spleen, small kidneys	Kidneys (水)	Quick · outgoing · passionate
So-eum (少陰人)	**水** (kidneys)	Large kidneys, small spleen	Spleen (土)	Delicate · analytical · introverted
Tae-yang (太陽人)	**金** (lungs)	Large lungs, small liver	Liver (木)	Original · driven · decisive

- A constitution's element is the element of its **large organ (大)**. Liver = 木, spleen = 土, kidneys = 水, lungs = 金. That is why each prescription addresses both a "strong place" and a "weak place."
- **火 is not addressed.** Sasang medicine divides constitutions by the relative size of four organs (lungs, spleen, liver, kidneys) and does not treat the heart (心, 火) as a basis for classification or prescription (conversation with Dr. Yim DongKoo, 10/20; confirmed by Director Ryu JeongKun, 10/25). Light and warmth are treated not as elemental prescriptions but as baseline comfort conditions for every space.

This assignment runs in the same direction as the type names of Eight Constitution Medicine (the Kwon Do-won lineage): Earth-Yang and Earth-Yin = So-yang, Wood-Yang and

Wood-Yin = Tae-eum, Water-Yang and Water-Yin = So-eum, Metal-Yang and Metal-Yin = Tae-yang. Eight Constitution Medicine is a separate school distinct from Sasang medicine, so we cite it only as "an interpretation in the same direction." Source: a study of harmonious and disharmonious colors by constitution type (master's thesis; "Constitution Fashion" materials; included in the integrated index).

3.2 The generating and controlling cycles

- **Generating cycle (相生, the supporting relationship)**: 木 → 火 → 土 → 金 → 水 → 木
- **Controlling cycle (相剋, the restraining relationship)**: 木 → 土 → 水 → 火 → 金 → 木

3.3 Four principles of space prescription: empower strengths, support weaknesses

1. **Reduce / sedate (瀉) what is strong** — A person already brings the energy of the large organ (the native element) with them. Piling it up in the space as well tips it into excess, so we take some away.
2. **Supplement / tonify (補) what is weak** — We fill in the energy of the small organ through material, color and scent to restore balance.
3. **Empower the strength** — We add the energy that generates (生) the native element, so the strength comes through well without overflowing.
4. **Support without excess** — If the supplementing energy controls (剋) the native element, use it subtly. Filling a weakness should never break a strength.

> Dr. Yim's example (Tae-eum, conversation of 10/20): take 木 away, and bring in the materials and concepts of 水 to further activate 木. Then supplement the weak lungs (金), but subtly, so that 金 does not restrain 木 (金剋木): matte metal and white linen instead of shiny metal.

Operating principles (reflecting Dr. Yim's draft of 10/20) - The five elements are a **symbolic language** of color, form and material, not rules that forbid real materials. Structural metal and necessary equipment are not removed, and the image of 水 can be expressed through light and surface without an actual water feature. - Structural, fire, ventilation and accessibility standards come first, and residents should be able to adjust

illuminance, color temperature and screening themselves. - Constitution alone does not fix every person's taste. The prescription is a starting point; the final judgement is the resident's comfort.

3.4 Prescription table by constitution

Constitution (element)	Reduce (瀉) · take from the strong	Supplement (補) · fill the weak	Empower the strength (生)	Intensity of support
Tae-eum (木)	木	**金** (supplements the lungs)	**水** (水生木)	Subtly — 金剋木
So-yang (土)	土	**水** (supplements the kidneys)	— (火生土, but 火 is not addressed)	Generously — 土剋水, so reduce 土 to keep 水 from being blocked
So-eum (水)	水	**土** (supplements the spleen)	**金** (金生水)	Subtly — 土剋水
Tae-yang (金)	金	**木** (supplements the liver)	**土** (土生金)	Generously — 金剋木, so reduce 金 to keep 木 from being suppressed

3.5 Accent colors: the reference colors of the 2021 constitution manuscript

Dr. Yim DongKoo's 2021 constitution manuscript ("Constitution Manuscript Notes") proposes the following reference colors for constitution analysis. In a space, they are used as **accent colors**.

Constitution	Reference color	PANTONE
Tae-eum	Yellow	13-0755 Primrose Yellow
Tae-yang	Green	15-0343 Greenery
So-eum	Orange	17-1462 Flame
So-yang	Blue	19-4045 Lapis Blue

The "recommended colors" on the 10/20 and 10/24 posters (pastel orange for So-eum, pastel yellow for Tae-eum, pastel blue for So-yang, pastel green for Tae-yang) match these references. In a space they are used as desaturated pastel tones. How these colors interlock with the elemental prescription is set out in a separate document, "Institute Observation: Constitution Reference Colors and the Five Elements" (pending Dr. Yim's review).

4. FIVE-ELEMENT DESIGN LEXICON

Element	Color	Material	Form	Objects & elements	Lighting & texture
木	Green, teal	Solid wood, bamboo, rattan, linen, cotton	Tall columnar shapes, stripes	Tall plants, wood carvings, wooden shelves	Natural light, matte grain
土	Yellow, ochre, beige, terracotta	Ceramics, earthen walls (clay, lime), limestone, brick	Low, wide rectangles, flatness	Ceramic vases, low tables, rugs	Soft diffused light
金	White, gray, silver, gold	Brass, steel, aluminum, white marble	Circles, arches, spheres	Metal frames, round mirrors, clocks	Reflected light, smooth surfaces
水	Black, navy, deep blue	Glass, mirror, high gloss, water	Waves, irregular forms, curves	Water basins and small fountains, ink-wash paintings, glass vases	Soft shadows, deep tones

火 (red, lighting, triangles) is not used in constitutional prescriptions. Lighting is a baseline condition of every room, left adjustable by the resident.

5. SPACE PRESCRIPTIONS BY CONSTITUTION

Tae-eum (木) — WATER ROOM "A great tree beside flowing water"

- **Reduce · take away 木**: Cut back on dark wood grain and repeated vertical louvers; keep surfaces simple. Avoid a forest-like room crowded with large potted plants.

- **Supplement・fill in 金 (subtly)**: Supplements the weak lungs. Matte metal details, white linen, rounded objects. Avoid shiny metal finishes (金剋木).
- **Empower・add 水**: Navy and blue-gray accents, soft curves, faint light that recalls a water surface. Glass vases, ink-wash paintings, a rug with a wave pattern.
- **Responses to check (Dr. Yim's draft)**: Is it visually restful? Does it feel neither cold nor dark? Are glare and touch appropriate? Does it suit reading, rest and conversation alike?
- **Accent color**: Yellow (Primrose Yellow) cushions and flowers.
- **Scent**: Peppermint (constitution reference oil) blended with lavender.
- **Living tip**: There is a tendency to accumulate things, so use closed storage to build a rhythm of clearing out.

So-yang (土) — BREEZE ROOM "A courtyard by the water, open to the breeze"

- **Reduce・take away 土**: Reduce clay walls, terracotta, thick rugs and heavy earthenware. Do not let low, heavy furniture pile up in one room.
- **Supplement・fill in 水 (generously)**: Supplements the weak kidneys. Pale blue glass, translucent partitions, blue-gray linen, low glass vases holding water, curves.
- **Empower**: 火 generates 土 (火生土), but 火 is not addressed. Instead, unobstructed circulation and open windows let this quick temperament move freely.
- **Accent color**: Blue (Lapis Blue).
- **Scent**: Grapefruit (constitution reference oil) + lemon.
- **Living tip**: This constitution runs hot easily, so keep the bedroom cool and well ventilated.

So-eum (水) — GOLD ROOM "A warm, golden study"

- **Reduce・take away 水**: Reduce glass, mirror and black surfaces, and do not place water basins.
- **Supplement・fill in 土 (subtly)**: Supplements the weak spleen. Ceramic objects close at hand, soft beige fabrics, a small rug. Avoid heavy finishes such as earthen walls (土剋水).
- **Empower・add 金**: Brass lighting, round mirrors and a round table, a white marble tray, silver frames.
- **Accent color**: Orange (Flame).

- **Scent**: Rosemary · ylang ylang (constitution reference oils).
- **Living tip**: This constitution feels the cold easily, so add floor warmth, layered wool blankets and a cozy corner for time alone.

Tae-yang (金) — EARTH ROOM "An earthen hill that holds a forest"

- **Reduce · take away 金**: Reduce metal furniture, glossy white surfaces and repeated circles.
- **Supplement · fill in 木 (generously)**: Supplements the weak liver. Solid wood furniture, linen, plants, tall vertical forms.
- **Empower · add 土**: Limestone and lime plaster, a low, wide ceramic table, sand beige and khaki fabrics.
- **Accent color**: Green (Greenery).
- **Scent**: Pine · tea tree (constitution reference oils).
- **Living tip**: With strong drive, this constitution struggles to rest, so add a floor-level seat that lowers the gaze.

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6. PUTTING IT INTO PRACTICE: FIVE STEPS

1. **Constitution assessment**: Confirm the resident's constitution through a constitution questionnaire (such as KS-15, the Sasang constitution questionnaire developed by the Korea Institute of Oriental Medicine) and expert consultation, and ask about preferences for light, sound and touch, as well as daily schedule.
2. **Five-element space audit**: For each room, classify materials, colors, forms, lighting and scent by element and record the current proportions (five-element checksheet).
3. **Prescription design**: Use the prescription table (3.4) to decide what to reduce, supplement and empower, then choose the accent color and scent.
4. **Construction and styling**: Change large surfaces (floors, walls, furniture) → medium surfaces (curtains, rugs, lighting) → small surfaces (objects, scent, artwork). Starting with small surfaces keeps costs low and shows the response sooner.
5. **Living review**: After two and four weeks, record changes in sleep, fatigue, focus and mood, and adjust.

When several constitutions share one home

- **Shared spaces (living room, kitchen)**: Keep the four elements evenly balanced, leaning slightly toward the majority constitution in the household. Provide light and warmth amply as baseline comfort conditions.
- **Private spaces (bedroom, study)**: Follow the prescription of the person whose room it is in full.
- **Scent**: Use widely suited blends such as lavender and lemon in shared spaces, and constitution reference oils in private ones.

7. CHECKLIST OF INTERIOR MATERIALS AND OBJECTS

Area	Tae-eum	So-yang	So-eum	Tae-yang
Floor	Dark-toned finish, deep-colored rug	Light wood, pale blue-gray rug	Warm wood + wool rug	Limestone + solid wood
Walls	Ink-black or navy accent wall, white linen curtains	White + blue accent	Warm white	Lime plaster, sand beige
Furniture	Glass and curves, matte metal details	Light, open forms, glass	Round forms and brass details, ceramic objects	Solid wood furniture + low ceramic table
Lighting	Soft indirect light	Natural light first, bright indirect light	Brass floor lamp	Diffused indirect light
Artwork	Ink-wash paintings, the sea	Lake and waterside landscapes	Golden abstract painting	Forest and land landscapes
Scent	Peppermint	Grapefruit	Rosemary · ylang ylang	Pine · tea tree

8. PRINCIPLES FOR AROMA AND DIFFUSERS

- Build around the constitution's reference oil and blend with **lavender, tea tree and lemon** (2021 constitution manuscript).
- Avoid synthetic air fresheners, and favor **ultrasonic diffusers or reed diffusion** over burning methods such as candles.
- In spaces with pets, infants or pregnant women, check oil types and concentrations separately, and diffuse intermittently: 30 to 60 minutes on, then a rest.
- Responses to scent differ from person to person. Start at a low concentration for the first week and record the response.

9. APPLICATIONS

- **Residential**: townhouses and multi-family housing (a membership tailored to residents' constitutions), premium pilot residences
- **Exhibition**: Korean pavilion at Milan Design Week — a participatory exhibition where visitors identify their constitution and experience four constitution rooms
- **Commercial spaces**: Constitution spas, constitution cafés, hotel guest rooms, corporate lounges
- **Education**: Constitution living feng shui coordinator course (Korea Constitution Life Institute)

10. NOTICE

- This guide is a lifestyle proposal that connects the Sasang constitution lifestyle with spatial design. The correspondence between constitutions and the five elements, and the space prescriptions by constitution, are the proposers' design interpretations and **are not clinically validated space prescriptions.**
- The value of a space is confirmed through the comfort, preference and usability felt by residents and visitors. We make no judgement about improvement of illness or long-

term health effects; confirming such effects would require a separate research design and ethical review.

- It does not replace the diagnosis or treatment of illness. Please consult a medical professional about health concerns.

SOURCES

1. Conversations with Dr. Yim DongKoo, 2026-10-20 (principles of constitution living feng shui) and 2026-10-24 (Milan Korean pavilion)
2. Yim DongKoo, "Constitution Feng Shui Space Design Proposal for Milan Design Week," draft (2026-10-20, 10 pages) and posters (10/20 · 10/21 · 10/24)
3. Yim DongKoo, "Constitution Manuscript Notes" (2021, Constitution Life Curation) — constitution reference aromas and reference colors
4. Ryu JeongKun, "Constitution Aromatherapy" manuscript (2021) — signature oils and blending principles by constitution
5. "Living Feng Shui for Your Constitution" — Yim DongKoo, constitution book, table of contents 2-13
6. A study of harmonious and disharmonious colors by constitution type (master's thesis; "Constitution Fashion" materials)
7. Lee Je-ma, Dongui Suse Bowon (1894) — the theory of relative organ size in Sasang medicine

FOUR CONSTITUTION ROOMS



WATER ROOM



BREEZE ROOM



GOLD ROOM



EARTH ROOM